

Interviewer: Okay. All good. Again, good day. Good day, [Participant's Name]. And thank you so much for participating in this interview. We'll start with a few demographics. [Participant's Name], how old are you?

Speaker: [26-30] years old.

Interviewer: [26-30]. Okay. And how long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker: [6-10] years now.

Interviewer: [6-10] years. I see. Do you currently have any children?

Speaker: None.

Interviewer: None. Okay. And who lives in the household or what's your household setup?

Speaker: Currently, living in my condo unit technically started out with my parents.

Speaker: Then my parents moved out and then [Partner's Name] has been staying with me since [Year] here in the condo.

Interviewer: Okay. So living together?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Okay. And what's your main source of income and your current job as well?

Speaker: Currently, I don't have as of this moment.

Interviewer: Okay. I see. And how would you like us to address your partner? Would you like to call us by name throughout the interview or partner, girlfriend?

Speaker: Any would be fine.

Interviewer: I'll just call her by her name.

Interviewer: Now [Participant's Name], can you tell me more about your love story?

Speaker: Well, it first started out. Actually, we were classmates for more over than [1-5] year. I was a higher batch than her, but due to some unforeseen circumstances, I wouldn't call it, but I would call it I was integrated into their batch. We really didn't notice each other for that year, but then suddenly I had an attraction to her and then there, I started chatting her and then I guess here we are now.

Interviewer: Okay. So when did this year, when did you become a classmate?

Speaker: This was, I believe, in between [Year] and [Year]. And then I started chatting her about late [Year].

Interviewer: Okay, [Year]. And then you got together what year?

Speaker: [Year].

Interviewer: [Year]. Okay. So what? It's already been [6-10] years.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Okay, I see. So classmate for more than [1-5] year and then a higher batch. You were in their batch and just started. Okay, I see.

Interviewer: Now, for sure you also have friends who are currently in a romantic relationship.

Interviewer: Now, how would you compare the quality of your relationship with [Partner's Name] to those of your friends' relationship?

Speaker: Well, I think with the friends, I know some of them already have children, some I think are already married and such. Actually, one of our best friends is here and she's also in a relationship more longer than us. And I think I can put a specific difference between our relationship and the rest of the relationship since I believe each relationship is unique. But as of yet, we really haven't talked about settling down yet even though we're already in our mid-[20-30s]. I think it's just a matter of financial freedom. I think we're not there yet to start a family unlike the others that are very excited to start a family. I think it's just more a matter of financial freedom, I guess. But if money is not an object, then I'd be more than happy to propose and get married.

Interviewer: I see. Now, in terms of quality, how would you compare the quality of friends' romantic relationships and the quality of your romantic relationship?

Speaker: Oh, yeah, sorry, I think I missed the point. But I think going back to what I said then, each relationship is unique.

Speaker: I think it's very, because what we see in social media is a very shallow introduction into what their other relationships actually are. We just see the good stuff, we don't see what really happens behind closed doors.

Speaker: So, I can't really say, but [Partner's Name] and I were very open to each other. We don't keep secrets from one another. I think it started out as me just being honest with her, telling everything, every little detail, what goes on in my day. This was back when we weren't still living together. But yeah, I think I don't really have an answer for that. But yeah, it's very unique. And yeah, again, it's what we see on social media because we're not that extroverted. We don't really have that much time to get to meet with some of our friends that are couples. But I think I hope I answered your question.

Speaker: I don't really have a definite answer.

Interviewer: It's okay, it's okay. Now, moving on, can I also ask if you had romantic relationships in the past before [Partner's Name]?

Speaker: Yeah, I did have a few, but if we want to talk like official relationships, I had my first girlfriend, but we were so young back then. It only lasted [1-5] month. It was more like puppy love and then I had some flings here and there before. But yeah, [Partner's Name] is the most serious in a relationship that I have been in.

Interviewer: I see. So it's just one of the official— It's puppy love. Now, how would you compare them, the quality of your relationship before the flings or the official ones, to your current relationship?

Speaker: Starting off with my first girlfriend, since she lives in [Country], we were just communicating via video chat. But then we didn't have, the reason why I broke it off so early is because we, like at that one

month mark, I didn't feel or we didn't have any solid foundation, I would say, to our relationship because although we knew each other from our childhood, but we didn't really interact.

Speaker: So yeah, again, it was a bit shallow. We were just attracted to one another. And then after my first girlfriend, other flings, it was more, I would guess the same, but without any official label. We just thought that we were attracted to or with those other girls, we had mutual attraction and then sexual, what do you call this, attraction as well. And yeah, that was just more like the foundation of my, I would say with the flings and sort of that.

Speaker: Yeah, it's very different with [Partner's Name]. It's more of a serious, loving, caring and deep emotional connection with her compared to the past.

Interviewer: I see. Now we're talking about quality, relationship quality. For you, what makes a relationship high quality?

Speaker: High quality, I would say the level of trust and communication is very important or I would say communication is key, right? But yeah, being honest with one another, building that trust is paramount to, well, of course, love is the most important.

Speaker: But when we're talking about the quality, I would say the level of trust and communication between partners is tantamount to anything else.

Interviewer: And for a low quality?

Speaker: Low quality, I would say miscommunication, misunderstanding, letting one's personal feelings get in a way, for example, when some couples fight. Because me personally, I think, because some people say, you know, don't go to bed without, you know, making up. But for me, I think it was because of my upbringing, I think sleeping it off is a better option. You know, because if you have a cool head, you'd be would make better decisions if you'd, you know, for example, with that saying, if you try to fix that before going to bed, what if you're really hot headed, you're hot-tempered, you might say something that, you know, once you say something, you can't take that back, even though if you didn't mean it, you still already said it.

Speaker: So I think, yeah, with some of my past flings, yeah, that was one of the problems. But now, although the, you know, going to sleep first doesn't really, or [Partner's Name] sometimes doesn't really favor that because she wants to talk it out, then if that's the case, then I try to talk it out best as I can, as calm as I can. But I firmly believe, you know, going to taking, even a nap would definitely help calm my head and, you know, not make me say or do anything rush.

Interviewer: I see.

Interviewer: Now, communication is more highlighted for you in terms of quality and relationship. Now, can you tell me more about how one knows that one is in a high quality or like one is in a communicating relationship?

Speaker: So communication is the most focused on quality of relationship rates. So yeah, how does one know? Like, you mean if I observe a couple, how would I know if they're in a quality relationship? I think, at first glance, I think knowing every intricate detail about one another means, of course, you talk to each other or maybe not even talk about it, but observing.

Speaker: I think, but basically I think it's more about knowing what your partner likes, what they dislike, what makes them happy, what makes them, you know, unhappy, knowing how to calm them, how to console with them. I think, I think it's about understanding your partner, getting to know them, how well you know your partner that I think goes into not keeping secrets from one another.

Speaker: So yeah.

Interviewer: I see. Thank you for that. Now, you also mentioned that love for you is the most important thing in the relationship. Why do you say so?

Speaker: I think in, you know, when we start relationships, I personally believe that it starts more, unless, for example, in my case, we didn't really know each other at first, but it was more of a physical attraction to her. And then it developed into something more because I believe other couples, you know, for example, my, I'm sorry, rather our best friend here, they really knew her and her boyfriend really knew each other for a very long time and then it suddenly developed into something.

Speaker: But with [Partner's Name], it started off as a physical attraction and then it became romantic to the point that we care about each other's futures. We want the best for one another. We want each other to grow when, during some mental breakdowns, we're there for one another, we try to understand. And, yeah, I think it's putting oneself before the other.

Speaker: Yeah, I hope I answered that.

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: Now proceeding to the next question. Well, parang scrapbook. But for you, what is love?

Speaker: I'm sorry?

Interviewer: For you, what is love?

Speaker: Love is something.

Speaker: Well, I remember one of my mom's teachings to me, she said that love goes both ways. We can't call, for example, when we like someone or love is only, you know, going one way, but you're not receiving that same amount of love. I think it goes both ways. And it's sacrifice, understanding, but basically putting oneself or your partner's well-being overall first before my own.

Interviewer: Now, you already highlighted love in your relationships, but just for the interview guide itself, how important is love for you in a relationship?

Speaker: It's very important. It's the foundation. It's basically the core of every romantic relationship. Yeah, I think that's basically my sentiment. It's the most important thing. It's the core. It's the foundation for everything else.

Interviewer: And how do you know that your partner loves you or in this case, how do you know that [Partner's Name] loves you?

Speaker: Yeah, because if I may share, I'm currently in a slump. Sometimes I feel unmotivated to apply for work currently, and she genuinely wants me to go out of my comfort zone for my betterment in general. It's not for her, it's for me. It's also for both of us, for our futures, because we need things, you know, basic necessities, and that costs money.

Speaker: And so basically, and she wants me to, you know, to, how do I say this? She wants me to, yeah, I think she wants me to go out of my comfort zone to try new things, you know. For example, I'm more of an introverted person, but for example, when there's a chance some of my high school friends, you know, want to meet up, she really pushes me, you know, go have fun, mingle with them, you know. It's fine with me, you know. Yeah, that's it.

Interviewer: So she really pushes you to go out of your comfort zone?

Speaker: Yeah, but not to the point, not just for the sake of it, but she's doing it, you know, for me, reminding me that, you know, you can do better, you have to.

Interviewer: I see, thank you for that. Now, would you also say that the relationship is good for you?

Speaker: Yeah, I think, I believe it's good for me.

Speaker: Going back to how we met, I was an upperclassman, but I had, I think I failed in this one major subject. That's why I wasn't able to get the, you know, since it was a prerequisite, the next subject for next semester, I couldn't get it. And then I got delayed [1-5] year, but I believe that was a, it was a silver lining because if that didn't happen, I didn't meet her, have met her. And yeah, it's, yeah, I think it's very important.

Speaker: It was my [inaudible], I'm sorry, the relationship with [Partner's Name] has definitely changed my life.

Speaker: I feel, well, I wouldn't call it negative, but I think now I couldn't live without her. Yeah, and with my mom, my mom, she's very supportive of our relationship.

Speaker: Whenever she addresses, for example, when my mom calls, when she refers to me, she also refers to her, like, love you both, she says something like that. So yeah, [Partner's Name] is like a part of my life now that I couldn't imagine if, you know, for unforeseen circumstances, we might, you know, separate or something would happen.

Speaker: You know, I think I would be very lost without her. So she's very important to me.

Interviewer: That's very good to hear. Now, moving on, let's move on to some challenges in your relationship. So what would you say are challenges in your relationship, whether in previous challenges, current or future one?

Speaker: Yeah, so what comes to mind is, I think early on, even like I would say [1-5] years ago, because naturally I'm more close to women because I grew up in a household. My mom, my aunts, all of my dad, my uncle, they were all to work.

Speaker: So naturally I have a more deep connection with women. But that's just, you know, a platonic, like for example, love, right? But since, if I would speak on [Partner's Name]'s behalf, I'm her first

boyfriend. So the challenges with having a romantic partner is at first very alien to her because she didn't have any previous experience.

Speaker: But since I did mention that I'm more close with women. And for example, when, in our first work, I had a close relationship with one of my co-workers, which she misunderstood. And, you know, she, even in our last work, I also had a very close relationship with one of my co-workers who's a woman, who's a girl. But, you know, she became, you know, she became jealous. She thought, you know, I was harboring feelings for both of them, I think, or not.

Speaker: But, you know, she just didn't like me because I'm an open book. I didn't mention, you know, communication, very important, and trust. So every detail that I'm not with her, I share with her. She doesn't make me report. I just, I'm naturally sharing it with her. I just want, because I'm very, once, you know, you get the ball rolling, I'm a very talkative person. I overshare sometimes.

Speaker: So yeah, she, because she heard that, you know, that name come up every so often. She mistook that as something else. She got jealous, you know. Yeah, but basically that was one of the main, one of our main problems or misunderstandings. And also, I think when it comes to our sex life, if I would say, because we're at, we are at very different levels, like my sex drive is higher while she isn't, you know, matching the level of mine. So, you know, sometimes I feel that, you know, our sex life isn't enough or it doesn't have, yeah, it doesn't have that much spice. Yeah, I think it's because of that, that level of difference we sometimes have misunderstandings.

Speaker: Although I try to understand her that, of course, that's not the, you know, the most important thing in a relationship. But I think our best friend would agree it's a very solid foundation, but not the most important. But yeah, that has been a struggle between us. But, you know, she tries to, how would I say it? She tries to, she tries to match when I want to, you know, do it. She would say yes, but sometimes, you know, begrudgingly. But yeah, she tries to, you know, to meet it. But I also try to step it down a bit for her because I also care about her feelings. I never, I would always ask permission and stuff. I don't do anything she wouldn't want me to do. So, yeah.

Interviewer: I see. Thank you for sharing that. And moving forward, we're talking about challenges, thoughts like new relationships. Do you and [Partner's Name] also fight?

Speaker: Yeah, we do. For example, fight, it, it, huh, our fights, basically their misunderstandings or, well, it's very rare, for example, we don't agree on something, then, you know, I'm not sure.

Speaker: I don't remember, but someone's voice, you know, goes a bit too high and the other misinterprets that one. And, yeah, and, you know, yeah, it's basically that misunderstanding. A wrong interpretation of what she or how I meant to say that something like that. And it escalates into, you know, what we have never, you know, we have never cursed or cussed at one another, but, you know, we just raised voice, our voice just, you know, gets raised.

Speaker: And, yeah, that's basically how, but if it's some simple misunderstanding, maybe probably after, after a few hours, we would, you know, we would talk normally again, as if it never happened. Yeah, but that's basically how we argue. We don't, yeah, basically that. And, you know, the previous story mentioned with me being close to other girls, she misinterpreted that. So, yeah, that's basically our fights.

Interviewer: And how did you resolve the one with the, with the misunderstanding on your closeness with a coworker?

Speaker: With the first one, I think, with the first one, one of my first co-workers, I just didn't mention her that much anymore, until she, you know, she cooled down with the second one. With the second one, it involved some other people talking to her that, you know, hey, I don't overthink this and this and that.

Speaker:[redacted]. And she was completely, she completely understood. But with how we solved it, I think I, I agreed that, you know, we wouldn't spend that much time and at work with one another, until, you know, [Partner's Name], she eventually, you know, she was eventually fine with it. But that, that friend of mine, that coworker of mine before, we still, we still talk to each other every now and then, not that often, but she eventually became okay with it, just, and they also reconcile with one another.

Interviewer: I see, that's great. And in terms of resolving fights, how long does it usually take before a fight is resolved?

Speaker: With regards to that one, what I said with the, you know, misunderstanding, you know, one raises one's voice. I think the longest was after, like, the next day, the next morning, everything was okay. Or if not, it would be over in a few hours. But with regards to that jealousy with my coworkers, the second one that actually took, I don't recall, but I would say more than a day. But I think, I can't really say, but I think maybe a month or a few, but, you know, nothing more than half a year. I don't recall, but yeah, maybe a few months, maybe.

Interviewer: So it varies, yeah, it varies depending on the gravity of it, but somehow shorter, shorter or solved.

Interviewer: Now, aside from talking it out and resolving things, what are other ways that you do, or you do, or you and [Partner's Name] does to maintain your relationship?

Speaker: I'm sorry, could you repeat that one again, please?

Interviewer: Okay, aside from talking it out, the one, the strategies you use to resolve your conflicts, what are other ways that you do, or you and [Partner's Name] does to maintain the relationship?

Speaker: How to maintain the relationship? For me personally, I think I'm very much already that much invested in our relationship that I would do my very best to make it work. But I think one, one strategy that are, yeah, but sometimes it always doesn't work out or she wouldn't agree at first with that. The thing I mentioned that sometimes I would rather, you know, sleep it out, maybe not talk to you for until tomorrow to cool down. Sometimes she doesn't agree with that. Sometimes she'd really push to, you know, talk this out. But sometimes for me, I wouldn't want to talk about that specific thing because it could be sensitive to me at the time.

Speaker: But in regards to making or maintaining the relationship, I think it's just that, as I mentioned earlier, I'm very much invested in our relationship and I couldn't imagine how my life would be if she were out of the picture. I think it would affect me, my entire mental stability, even my identity, if I would say, because we are that much already invested in one another.

Interviewer: Now, speaking of identity, did the relationship also change you?

Speaker: Yes, yes, because I would say yes. I'm not exactly sure what specific word I could use to describe it, but it, because if I, yeah, I don't have that specific word. But if I think about it, how my life would be, it would, I think it would be just the opposite, you know, I would be lost. I wouldn't have that much motivation to do something because she motivates me. She pushes me out of my comfort zone for my betterment, for our betterment. So, yeah, I would think it would be the complete opposite. Like I would be just stuck at home. If I had work, probably it would be a different career, or me just being at home doing nothing productive, I would say, yeah, it would be totally different. I couldn't use a specific word, yeah.

Interviewer: Now, what about your partner? Did they also change in their relationship, or during their relationship, rather?

Speaker: Yeah, with that misunderstanding with my coworkers, she's now, well, I explained it to her that, you know, I grew up in a house full of, you know, full of women and that, and I, because, you know, unfortunately, toxic masculinity, for example, you can't share, you know, what you're feeling with other guys too much, they might think yourself. So, basically, I naturally am more, you know, open with my thoughts with women. So, she came to terms with that, she understood, oh, if I may, for example, one of our fights before is because our best friend, [Name], I think she's the first girl that I had a deep connection with, you know, very platonic, and at the time she just lives at the next condo,

Speaker: [Partner's Name] lives, well, her house is about [16-20] kilometers from where we live right now. So, during a time, I think it was summer break, since [Name] lives just here, if we, if he had problems, or if I had problems, we were able to meet downstairs, you know, be there for one another. If [Partner's Name] had, you know, problems, she, at the time, because at the time we didn't have a motorcycle, so, and traffic is very difficult. So, if she had problems, she didn't have me at her disposal, if I could say, to vent out, unlike our best friend. So, that was one of our problems, but she, because at the time she was, if I could say she was a bit irrational, [Name] thinks, because she might have hormonal imbalance, but now, [Partner's Name], she's more understanding now, she accepted it, that, yeah, she realized that she was over-acting, because, you know, what could we do? She's, we're both right there, and she's there, so, you know, what could we do, you know?

Speaker: But, yeah, she realized, she realized that it was irrational, her, well, it wasn't jealousy, but I think it was just that she didn't have anyone near to her, you know, she could, she could come forward with her problems, but, yeah, she eventually, she realized, sometimes, if I may add, early on in the relationship, if I had a problem with her, I, you know, chat a friend, she didn't appreciate it, because, you know, it's our problem, it's personal, but the good thing is that I believe is, it gives, for example, when I tell her, you know, you should talk to someone also about what were our problem, what we're fighting over, because it gives the both of us a, it gives the both of us—

Speaker: She just woke up—

Speaker: — it gives the both of us a new perspective, you know, a, for example, a thought outside the box gives us a new perspective, so, when that happened with [Name], she, or with some of our other friends, she also, you know, gives her a new perspective, that, yeah, she might have overreacted and stuff, so, yeah, I think that's it.

Interviewer: Now, moving on to the next part of her question, do you also feel safe in the relationship?

Speaker: Yeah, I do, I do, 100% I do.

Interviewer: And why do you say so?

Speaker: Again, we deeply care for one another, we want the best, we want the best for one another, we push each other out of our comfort zone, sometimes, you know, she may feel insecure, we talk about it, but, you know, basically, we're there for one another, we don't, again, we don't keep secrets from one another, for example, if a friend, you know, they talk to us in confidence, I tell that friend, if you're telling me she's gonna know about it, you know, because I'm just generally open to her about it, so, that level of, you know, that level of trust that we have for one another, it makes me feel safe. Never had a single doubt, for example, when, for example, when, even early on in the relationship, for example, when it comes down, you know, like money, hey, can you hold on to this one, never had a single doubt that, you know, she might take something without me knowing, and vice versa, so, yeah, I'd say we're, I'd feel very safe with her.

Interviewer: I see. Now, for the next part of our interview, I'll be sharing my screen in a while.

Speaker: Sure.

Interviewer: Okay, there.

Speaker (Referring to someone in the background): There's an interview. For thesis.

Interviewer: Okay, can you, can you see my screen?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Okay. Okay, so for the next part, I'll be showing you two statements. Okay, I won't start a slideshow (inaudible). So, there. So, what you're going to do is on a scale of one to nine with one as not at all true and nine as completely true, your task is just to rate your agreement to this statement. So, the first statement is my partner usually really listens to me. How would you rate your agreement?

Speaker: Is there like 0.5? Is that acceptable, like something like 0.5 or should it be a whole number?

Interviewer: As much as possible a whole number, but, yeah.

Speaker: Okay. Okay, my partner usually really listens to me. I think at eight, because sometimes, you know, we're, we're in bed and we're on our phones. She, or for example, I would share something, then if I looked her, you know, she's on her phone. Like, what did I say? Then she's blank, but every time, but if it's the opposite, for example, I'm very, I'm very, you know, buried in my phone, she would ask me something. I could say it back to her, but vice versa, she couldn't do that to me. But yeah, that's, but, you know, but aside from that in general, yeah, she really listens to me. I think it's just that because of just that instance, I would say. If I could answer 8.5, but just because of that instance, I would say.

Interviewer: Okay, I see. Now for the next statement, my partner usually is responsive to my needs. So same scale on a scale of one to nine. How would you rate your agreement to this statement?

Speaker: My needs. My needs. When, when, when I, when you said that what came to my mind, what I shared earlier with regards to, you know, you know, this, I think sexual needs, right? So we're very far apart. You know, so I would have to adjust. She would have to adjust, but it still isn't, you know, 100% we're both in that level. So, but, you know, aside from that, yeah, I would say, well, yeah, I think that's,

well, like what I mentioned, our best friend says, you know, that level of understanding sexually is very important. So then I would say about seven.

Interviewer: Seven.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: So you rated eight for the first statement. My partner usually really listens to me and then answered your reason for such as well. But if I can just probe a little bit, why not seven or why not nine?

Speaker: Seven or nine. Well, honestly, this is just because of my personal belief. For example, I don't believe. Well, that anyone is an expert in their field because, you know, there's so much yet to be learned, discovered. So, you know, everything's not at 100%. That's what I believe. So coming back to this one, because, you know, I can't, we can't read people's minds, you know, like for her, what I mentioned with, you know, when we're on our phones, that's what I only observe. But, you know, in reality, I'm not sure how much she would retain specific information because I also can't all the time remember something like, I think, for example, I, the most common thing, for example, if I tell a story, I'm not exactly sure who, if I already, for example, if we were your friends, right? If I told you something, then I tell some other people, then I don't recall. Have I told you this already? Something like that.

Speaker: So, but, you know, basically. But basically, I, we can't read people's minds. So I wouldn't know if she really retains some of the information, but yeah. Hope I answered that.

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah, yeah. Now, moving on to the second one, my partner usually is responsive to my needs. So you initially thought of the sexual one, but just to probe again, similar to the previous one, why not six or why not eight, in this case?

Speaker: Why not? So basically, why not lower? Because, you know, I think it was down again to be deeply care for one another. We want to do our best. If she does one thing, I would do another thing. How would I say this? For example, in our setting, I do the laundry. And if there is, you know, food available, she would, she's the one who's going to cook. But, you know, I do that or we do that without, you know, expecting maybe, I think maybe she does a bit. And like, but when it comes to, you know, fulfilling what we need every day, we do really important things, so to speak. We really do.

Speaker: For example, even though like the concert of [Name], the K-pop group, I mean, she's really, she's really a fan girl. We, you know, I borrowed my mom's car. We went the hot trip. I didn't watch. I was just in the parking lot the entire duration because that's what she really wants. But, you know, I'm there to support her. She wants to be happy, you know, go ahead. That's that kind of stuff.

Speaker: But again, with the, you know, the sexual thing, I think that's just the only thing that we're not, you know. But because I don't want to, you know, I don't want to force her doing something she doesn't want to do. For example, she doesn't want to do it now. Then I don't really, I think it "nangungulit" would be the appropriate term, but I couldn't force myself on to her or something like that. Yeah. So, you know, those two different things. I, for example, also when she has places to be, even though I won't benefit or it really hasn't, or really doesn't have something to do with me, I really go out of my way and such. So, I think those are the two examples that I could think of.

Interviewer: And thank you as well for sharing that. Now, moving on, although we're already somehow talking about it, but I hope you don't mind if I ask and feel free to share. But we also wanted to know

about your physical intimacy as a couple. Yeah, we've been talking about it, but how often do you have sex?

Speaker: So, recently, a lot since we actually just celebrated, or we just actually came back from [City B] and [City C] to celebrate our [6th-10th] anniversary. Not exactly specifically on those dates, but we just had to move it a few days because of our work schedule and stuff. And for the entire month, or [Month] and the half of [Month], I was in our province. So, you know, we're quite far apart. I was in [City D], and so yeah, we came back, you know, a bit often. But if we have been together with each other for a couple of months at a time, it really depends. Sometimes, you know, I think the most before was like every day, but that was before like, before early in our relationship, it was more often. And then I think about last [1-5] years ago, maybe sometimes it would even, I think at the most, [1-5] weeks was at the most like nothing at all. But it really, it really depends on the situation. Like, I was gone for almost [1-5] months, and then we were celebrating our [6th-10th] anniversary. So, you know, it's like (pagbigyan mo na— inaudible). And then, maybe if I may share that time, the last co-worker that I have, she's jealous, so she would go out of her comfort zone. I think she's jealous. But if we're okay, it really depends.

Interviewer: I see. But how satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker: Yeah, going back again, honestly, you know, the level of men are so different out of what number?

Interviewer: No scale, no number, but in general. Given all those, you have talked about this topic.

Speaker: So, we're out of ten, maybe at a six or seven, maybe.

Interviewer: Okay. Okay, now moving on for actually towards the end of the interview, I'll be sharing my screen once again.

Speaker: Sure.

Interviewer: Okay. Can you see my screen?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Okay. Now moving on, in general, how satisfied are you with your relationships with [Name]? So, just answer, just choose an answer.

Speaker: Yeah, I would say very satisfied. Again, you know, going to what I said, you know, for example, I don't believe in experts, nothing is really at 100%. That's why I was asking, is there's an option like a 0.5 or something? So, yeah, I would say very satisfied, but, you know, we do fight and we have misunderstandings, so I would put it at very satisfied. Very satisfied.

Interviewer: Now, if we were to put a number to that satisfaction, how would you rate your satisfaction with your relationship? Now on a scale of 0, is not at all satisfied, so 10 as completely satisfied?

Speaker: Yeah, if there was a 9.5, I would say a 9 because, you know, of the sexual aspect, you know, that's just basically it, but overall 9.

Interviewer: I see, so that's a 9. Okay. Now, 9. Okay, now we're close to, we're close to wrapping up and moving forward, I would just like to summarize what we have discussed about the past hour. So, I'll be summarizing and then feel free to butt in if you would like to add or correct anything.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: Now, starting off with your demographics, you're [26-30] years old, so in a [6-10]-year relationship with [Partner's Name], no children yet, you're living in a [place], so living together since [Year], and as for your love story, you were a classmate for more than [1-5] year, you were an upper class, upper batch, but then you got integrated with their batch, and then, you know, then it starts with attraction and you got to that in [Year]. In terms of when, in terms of your relationship quality compared to that of your friends, some of your friends already have children, some of them are already married, but you can't put a specific difference because as you have mentioned, each relationship is unique. And quality for you, in terms of quality, comparing, in terms of quality, in social media, you just can't see what's behind, so you only see the good stuff. So, although you and [Partner's Name] are very open, you're very honest to each other as well. And then as for your previous relationships, you had [1-5] official girlfriend, but it only lasts for [1-5] month, so we're on puppy love, and then you broke off because you didn't have any solid foundation, and it's very shallow as well. And she's the same without the official label. So if you were to compare, more serious, more loving, more caring in your relationship, more with [Partner's Name]. And high quality relationship for you is when the level of trust and communication is important. So that's what you also highlighted when you were comparing between high quality and low quality relationships.

Interviewer: And in terms of love, for you, love is the most important thing in a relationship because, in your case, you start in the physical attraction and then romantic. But then later on, you want each other to grow, you understood each other, and then you put oneself behind, you put yourself first before your partner. Now, in terms of your definition of love, for you, love goes both ways. And then you also added that sacrifice, understanding, and putting your partner's well-being is also important. Love for you is the foundation and the core of a romantic relationship. And you know that your partner or your [Partner's Name] loves you because she genuinely wants you to go out of your comfort zone for your betterment and for the relationship's betterment as well. And yeah, she really pushes you, especially currency that you're somehow unmotivated in life and in work as well. You also said that the relationship is good for you because how you met, if that didn't happen, your life would be completely opposite. She's already a part of your life now.

Interviewer: And then as for challenges in a relationship, one major challenge is, naturally, you're more close to women because you grew up in a household that has more women. And Her, she didn't have any previous experiences because she, you were her first boyfriend. And then somehow jealous with your relationship or your closeness with a coworker. Although later on, she completely understood it. You had some friends talk to her about it. And then over time, she also got to understand and agree that it's really your natura— nature in you. And then another challenge is in terms of your sex life. So somehow, your sex drive is higher compared to hers. And then it's more difficult to match the levels. So sometimes you have to step down and then sometimes she compensates for it.

Interviewer: And then in terms of your fights, you also fight and you have also misunderstandings. But you resolve it by talking normally, sometimes greeting it out. And in terms of duration, she didn't fight. You resolve it faster. There are other challenges, but it's not really nothing more than half a year as you mentioned. And in terms of your maintaining the relationship, you already invested in the relationship and up until now you're still doing your best too to make it work. And then as for change, your answer is that the relationship changes you. But you don't know what word or what description to use.

Interviewer: But in terms of comparison, (inaudible) your life did not change. And in terms of her side, you also mentioned that she changed during the relationship because she's more understanding and she's more open, especially with the previous challenges you encountered as well. And then as for safety, you also mentioned that you feel safe in the relationship because you genuinely want what's best for one another and you're pushing each other out of the comfort zone. And when I asked you about the statements, so you rated 8 for the first statement, my partner usually really listens to me because you specified one encounter at night when you're in your phone. Sometimes she's just blank when you share something but vice versa, you respond back. And then not 7 or 9 because you believe that not anyone is an expert in their field.

Interviewer: So not everything or everyone is at their 100 percent. And then as for the second statement, rated 7, and you initially thought of sex and not 6 or 8 because, again, you want what's best for each other. You fulfill each other's needs. Again, you mentioned the chores that you both do in the condo.

Interviewer: And in terms of the sexual needs, you just don't force yourself to her as well. And then as for the frequency of sex as well, recently a lot because you just came back from celebrating your anniversary. And then normally somehow every day and it depends on the situation in general. But in terms of satisfaction out of 10, 6 or 7 as you have mentioned. And then in summary, you're generally very satisfied with your relationship rating in 9. So, did I get that right? Is there anything else you'd like to add?

Speaker: Perfect. You got everything.

Interviewer: Okay.

Interviewer: Now, before we end, I want to talk to you about how we will handle data and of course the research project. We want to be as ethically transparent as possible. And so I wanted to know which data sharing option you are most comfortable with. Now, we have two options. Option one is that transcript portions can be shared, none of which can be identified to you. So the de-identified transcript can also be read by other researchers.

Interviewer: And option two, if you're a bit bolder, the whole transcript can be shared, removed of sensitive and overly identifying details. Such as your name, your location, your work, or the place you're living at, something like that. So it will be anonymized. Although in this option, there's a very minimal chance that someone who knows you well might piece together and then narrow it down, which among their colleagues is that. But of course that would take them so much time because they'd have to review the whole transcript. They'd have to review the whole references. Although again, no sensitive information will be shared. So of those two options, which are you most comfortable with?

Interviewer: Yeah, I'm fine with the second option.

Interviewer: Okay. Now, thank you so much again for participating and I'd like you to know that this study is also being done not only here in the Philippines. So it's also done in Brazil, Turkey, France, and the United States. And for this study to be successful with one last thing for you, is that okay?

Interviewer: So can you recommend two close people in your life as a nominator? So what will happen is, the two people you will provide we will be asking them couples that we can interview for this

research project. So they won't be the ones interviewed. They will be the ones to provide couples to interview

Speaker Right now, I think I'd have to thank first.

Interview: Yeah, it's okay. You can forward it to [Partner's Name]. And then I'll be needing their name, contact number, and email.

Interviewer:: Okay, sure. And then you can just provide the heads up or at least they know that they will contact them as well. Okay, let me just stop recording.